



appears at startup. So I doubt if Firewall is protecting me whenever I access the net. Neither does it update itself even if automatic updates are turned on. I have set it to update everyday at 11 am as I use the net at that time.

3. I have a D-Link ADSL 2+ Router. Just recently I have known from a friend that my Broadband connection (256 kbps) is not giving me the required speed. It mostly stays at 25-30 kbps whereas I found at my friend's place that he gets a minimum speed of 80kbps. I checked my modem at my friend's home and it is working fine. The telephone exchange told me that my telephone line is okay.

4. I have Avast 4.8 (registered Home Edition) and Spybot Search and Destroy installed and update it regularly. They show no errors or viruses on scanning even at 'thorough scan'. But after I bought the Kaspersky antivirus, it has started showing a lot of errors. Why? Aren't free home editions reliable? My broadband provider says your net might be slow because I am using a free edition and so my computer is infected with virus.

I am not thinking of using dual antivirus as I don't think my pc could handle it.

A If you are sure the keyboard works fine on other PCs, then the problem lies with the connector on your PC. Try cleaning it and make sure it isn't damaged. It could be something much sillier that could be wrong. Click on Regional and Language Options in the Control Panel. Click on the Languages tab and then on Details. Make sure the keyboard layout is correct. Make sure Sticky keys and other accessibility options are turned off from the Control Panel as well.



Notifications from Security Center can be enabled through the Control Panel

If your Windows Security option isn't visible on the system tray, then you might have disabled in the past. Other anti-spyware, anti-virus and firewalls can disable the Windows firewall during installation as well. To enable it again, go to the Security Center from the Control Panel. Click on Change the way Security Center alerts me. Here you can choose to have

the system tray icon displayed. To verify if the update downloading is enabled, click on Automatic updates and Windows Firewall in the Control Panel.

Your 256 kbps connection should give you around 30 kilobytes per second. If your friend gets 80 kilobytes per second on his 256 kbps connection, then his connection isn't working properly by giving him a higher speed.

The efficiency of an antivirus application depends on its engine and how often virus updates are released online. There are way too many virus and worms on the Internet and many released every single day.

System Configuration For CAD And 3D Modeling

Q I'm an architecture student and an advance user of AutoCAD Architecture 2009, Revit Architecture 2009, 3ds Max 9, Photoshop CS3, Corel Draw and V-Ray for rendering. I use them for making technical drawings, Panels, rendering and walkthroughs. I want to upgrade my PC. I've figured out the following configuration:

Processor: Intel Core2 Duo E8500 3.16 GHz
Motherboard: Asus Formula Rampage OR Asus P5Q Pro

RAM: Transcend 2X2GB DDR2, 800 MHz
Graphics card: XFX GeForce 8800GTS, 512MB Alfa Dog OR ATI Radeon HD3870, 512MB
Power supply: Cooler Master 600W

Most probably I'll be using Windows Vista Home Premium SP1. Kindly suggest necessary changes in the configuration. What is the cost of a 4GB DDR3 RAM? Is it better? Also, suggest a free but powerful Antivirus. My Budget is Rs 45,000 approx.

Nitin Kashyap

A Your configuration needs a few corrections. Quad-core processors will suite your work better than a dual-core E8500. An entry level quad-core - the Intel Q6600 which is around Rs 9,000 would be a far better option for rendering purposes. More the cores the better it is for rendering. DDR3 is still a lot more expensive than DDR2 at the moment. 4 GB of DDR3 could be priced anywhere around Rs _____. The advantages of using DDR3 aren't visible right now so DDR2 is your best bet.

As far as your selection of graphics cards go, you should opt for the GeForce 8800GTS. Prices for graphics cards have plummeted, so can even consider cards like the ATI Radeon 4850 at around Rs. 11,000. GeForce 9800GTX cards are also available around the same price.

The two ASUS boards you have mentioned use two completely different chipsets. The Formula Rampage is one of the best X48 boards one can buy but it should be a bit more expensive than the P5Q-Pro. Look at your budget and choose accordingly because the P45 powered P5Q-Pro is also a very good board at its price bracket.

If you are going for a Cooler Master, make sure you go for one from the Real Power series. You can also look for power supplies from the other manufacturers such as the Corsair HX620. All the above components should easily fit in your Rs 45,000 budget.

Looking For A Digital Camera And A Digital Camcorder

Q I am planning to buy a digital camera and a handy cam. I will be using it for my tours/family functions at the most. For the digital camera, based on digit/other reviews I have decided to buy Canon PowerShot A590 IS. Is A720IS worth the extra money for 6x zoom? I have also settled on canon because it has an optical viewfinder and will help in saving battery life. Are my assumptions correct? Are there any better cameras for around Rs 8000 to 10,000. Kindly advice.

For handy cam I have settled on Canon FS10/ FS11. Are they good? Among others I settled on them due to their storage. I feel that they will be more stable compared to hard disk based cams. Is this correct? My budget is around Rs 24,000 to 26,000. Please advice.

V. Rajaraman

A The A590 IS and A720 IS are both very good cameras for their prices. The A720 is worth the extra money you spend. Not only does it have a slightly more powerful zoom lens but it also is slightly superior in quality. Using the optical viewfinder might save a little bit of battery power but using it all the time is not always going to be possible.

The Canon FS 10 should be around your budget price range but keep in mind these are SD-based camcorders. They are quieter and the batteries should last longer than on hard drive and tape based ones.

Need A Configuration For Computer Graphics And Animation Creation

Q I want to buy a PC and my Budget is Rs 30,000 to 35,000. I am doing a course of animation and VFX. Please tell me the best configuration that I can get in this budget. Also mention the prices of the required hardware like CPU, motherboard, RAM, graphics card, LCD monitor and must tell about cabinet and the power supply. Tell me which O/S is better for animation and gaming - XP or Vista. Also tell about a good internal T.V. tuner card.

Sanchit Jindal

A For a budget of Rs 35,000, you should be able to get the following components with these approximate prices.
Processor: Intel Core 2 Duo E7200 (Around Rs 5,500)

Motherboard: Abit IP35-E or Biostar TP35D2-A7 (Around Rs 5,000)
Graphics card: GeForce 9600GT (Around Rs 6,500)
Memory: 2 GB DDR2 Value RAM (Around Rs 2,000)
Hard drive: Western Digital 640GB (WD6400AAKS)
LCD Screen: 19" Samsung (Around Rs 8,500)
Power supply: VIP 500W
Generic cabinet

Windows Vista and XP are both fine for gaming as well as computer graphics work. Vista is definitely prettier but also consumes a lot more memory. With the 2 GB of RAM you put on your system, Vista should run just alright.

Looking To Buy A Laptop

Q I am planning to purchase a laptop in November. I want a 256MB graphics card with DirectX 10 support, an AMD dual core processor, a 120 to 160 GB HDD, 2 GB of RAM along with features like a webcam, HDMI port, a LAN card, WiFi, Bluetooth and a Lightscribe DVD writer.

I have looked up on the Internet and have found products like the HP DV5z (which has not been launched in India yet), the Dell Studio and some others from Acer.

I've a budget of Rs 35000 to Rs 40000. I need to know if the Hp one that is shown as \$700 to 900. Is this price going to be the same in the Indian market also and by what time this product is going to come in India. I need your assistance to buy a laptop for the value of money in my range of budget.

Bivash Krishna Bala

A Typically when products reach the Indian shore, prices go up by a bit but there are also times when they are cheaper here than in some other countries. In the case of the HP laptop you've been talking of, HP India would know best. Check up on HP India's site for any information or try and contact them from their site.

You should also know that features such as Bluetooth, WiFi, a webcam and a wired LAN card are common in almost all laptops today. A light scribe enabled DVD writer is a little more difficult to find. HDMI and DirectX 10 supported graphics cards with dedicated memory are some features usually found on costlier laptops.

Need A Mobile Phone With Good Sound And A Good Camera

Q Hi, I am going to buy a new mobile. It should have a good camera, good sound and memory at least of 2 GB. There is no need of features like 3G. I travel a lot so the phone should be built well too. Please suggest a mobile phone for me. My price range is between Rs 13,000 and Rs 15,000.

